

CONVICTS AND colonization

SETTLING IN THE ANTIPODES

The history of women in Australia and New Zealand reflects the impacts of colonization on the lifestyle, identity, and freedom of both the colonized (the Aboriginal and Māori indigenous peoples) and the colonizers (the European settlers—not all of whom were willing migrants).

Prior to European arrival, Australia had been inhabited for more than 60,000 years. Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islanders lived in small communities, often moving around, and had a strong sense of kinship and responsibility for the land. Aboriginal people have an oral tradition for sharing their history

12,500

women were
shipped to
Tasmania as
punishment for
their crimes,
mainly theft.

